

CYBER SECURITY

ROADMAP

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This roadmap is for anyone trying to get into cyber security. The aim is to achieve a well rounded and foundationally strong base to set you up for success as a beginner within this domain.

The goal is to not try and rush the process rather follow it in a way that makes sense to you and helps you learn and understand the steps you are following

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Royden Rahul Rebello
The Social Dork

STEP 1

FOUNDATIONAL SKILLS

There are 3 foundational domains you should focus on before getting into the core cyber concepts and they are:

- Operating systems
- Networking
- Databases

Courses covering these are below

Networking:

Jeremy IT CCNA - <https://www.youtube.com/watch>

[v=H8W9oMNSuwo&list=PLxbwE86jKRgMpuZuLBivzIM8s2Dk5IXBQ_](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=H8W9oMNSuwo&list=PLxbwE86jKRgMpuZuLBivzIM8s2Dk5IXBQ_)

ComPTIA Network+ Professor Messer - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?>

[v=k7IOOn3TiUc8&list=PLG49S3nxzAnl_tQe3kvnmeMid0mjF8Le8](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=k7IOOn3TiUc8&list=PLG49S3nxzAnl_tQe3kvnmeMid0mjF8Le8)

Zero to Mastery - <https://links.zerotomastery.io/comptianetwork-socialdork-oct2025>

Linux

FREE code camp - [youtube.com/watch?](https://www.youtube.com/watch?)

[v=sWbUDq4S6Y8&pp=ygUWTGludXggYmVnaW5lZXJzIGNvdXJzZQ%3D%3D_](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sWbUDq4S6Y8&pp=ygUWTGludXggYmVnaW5lZXJzIGNvdXJzZQ%3D%3D_)

Network chuck Linux for hackers - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?>

[v=ugt3PBeqHlo&list=PLIhvc56v63IJlujb5cyE13oLuyORZpdkL&index=10](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ugt3PBeqHlo&list=PLIhvc56v63IJlujb5cyE13oLuyORZpdkL&index=10)

Databases

Programming with Mosh - https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7S_tz1z_5bA

Free code camp full beginner database course -

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HXV3zeQKqGY>

STEP 2

CORE CYBER SECURITY SKILLS

Once you are done with the foundational skills you then move on to learning and understanding about cybersecurity from a broad level perspective. In order to do that focus on the COMPTIA Security+ first. It offers a good blend of various cyber domains which will also help you understand which domain you would eventually specialize in down the track in your career.

Courses covering these are below

Zero to Mastery Security+ - <https://links.zerotomastery.io/comptiasecurity-socialdork-oct2025>

Professor Messer CompTIA security+ - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KiEptGbnEBc&list=PLG49S3nxzAnI4QDVqK-hOnoqcSKEIDDuv>

Certification Kit for Security + - <https://www.amazon.com.au/CompTIA-Security-Certification-Michael-Pastore/dp/0470285923>

Jason Dion practise exams - <https://www.udemy.com/user/jason-dion/>

Study plan for the Network+ and Security+ - <https://youtu.be/bBX-AX2Xc5g>

While studying the CompTIA Security+ you can also do other foundational cyber courses/certs such as the ones below:

- Google cybersecurity course
- ISC2 Certified in cybersecurity (very beginner level)

STEP 3

HANDS ON LABS

In cyber security HANDS-ON labs are the most important. Studying theoretical stuff is great but actually putting that to practise is what is needed. Use the below resources for a good blend of cyber home labs:

1) **WAZUH SIEM Home Lab**

Home lab by running a SIEM and XDR solution in WAZUH and set up everything from scratch using Virtual Box, Ubuntu etc. Learn how to download and install the WAZUH tools such as a WAZUH manager, agent and also learn file and integrity monitoring by changing the configs on the WAZUH agent.

<https://youtu.be/QT81wcuoRFY>

2) **PFSENSE Home Lab**

Cybersecurity home lab by running a network firewall called PFSENSE and set up everything from scratch using Virtual Box, Kali Linux, Ubuntu etc. Learn how to download and install the PFSENSE firewall, set up the DHCP scopes, management access, firewall rules and also attack the Ubuntu machine using HPING from a Kali Linux VM and eventually block the malicious traffic.

<https://youtu.be/-yRvfbEIT7M>

3) **SafeLine WAF Home Lab**

Home lab that you can add to your resume to get yourself hired. Install and run a web application firewall provided by SafeLine and set up everything from scratch using Virtual Box, Kali Linux, Ubuntu, Apache web server, self signed certificates using OpenSSL etc.

<https://youtu.be/N0dEC1nuWCQ>

4) **Cloud security GitHub Repo:**

Hands-on beginner projects for securing cloud resources in AWS, Azure, and GCP.

<https://github.com/Oxrajneesh/Cloud-Security-Projects-For-Beginners>

5) **WireShark Home lab video**

Learn how to use Wireshark to easily capture packets and analyze network traffic. View packets being sent to and from your network connected devices, scan for malicious network activity and learn how to navigate through all of the sniffed packets.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qTaOZrDnMzQ>

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

Try Hack me Hands on Labs - <https://tryhackme.com/classrooms>

Hack the box labs - <https://www.hackthebox.com/hacker/hacking-labs>

The Social Dork Home Lab Playlist - <https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PL4lVSt1uV5TIHRTxFggr-QB1QJltaZ6YF>

FREE Cybersecurity home lab videos - <https://youtu.be/pSL3g44Suu4>

TCM security FREE tier - <https://tcm-sec.com/free-tier-launch/>

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Getting into cyber security is not rocket science nor does it need you to splurge money on unnecessary courses. Yes, there are courses and certifications that make sense to invest in but they should be done in a sensible manner with thought put into it.

Following this roadmap and these resources will help you develop and sharpen your skills as a beginner within cybersecurity. All the best!

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